

Mekong & the Commies



The Legend of Balinese DonMu – Book One (Part III of III) – Chapter 39

I hustled up away from the woodshed over to the little dirt path and jumped inside the row of red hibiscus and yellow frangipani trees underneath the 10' foundation wall of the hotel – where the Klan boys couldn't hear me – and pulled out my phone and saw about 20 missed calls and texts from Olof and Wing. And immediately thought ... *Uh oh, that can't be good* ... so scrolled up to the first one and started reading it.

"Karen is dressed up as one of the Skybirds going around drugging all the trail mix and water jugs!"

Oh shit!! I thought. *Cooter was just munching down all that stuff ... Muskrat and Varmint too. Uh oh, that can't be good.*

But then I wunner'd bout dat ... maybe that'd be a good thing for them?

I didn't know.

Maybe?

Then continued reading.

"That backpack she grabbed out of Sky's room was full of all kinds of mushrooms, peyote buttons, ayahuasca, LSD, DMT, and all kinds of other stuff we've never even heard of before!"

Then I remembered Hippie Jon.

Oh crap!

He ate an entire bag of that trail mix. German Gunther too. Plus they were drinking all that brownish mud-water and alkalized water in those water jugs – which must have been little pieces of acid floating around in there. *Uh oh* I thought. He also said he was starting to feel all tingly inside like he was an astronaut about to be shot out into space.

Yikes!

I cringed at the thought of that.

Then figured I'd call them back, so scrolled through my phone, found Olof's name on it, hit 'Call' and he answered immediately.

"Why the hell've you been talking to those Klan guys for so long?!"

Ummmm ... "Yeah. Sorry about that. But wait. Was that really Karen dressed up as one of the Skybirds drugging all the trail mix and water bottles around here?"

“Yeah, but forget about that for now. We’ve actually got bigger problems!”

“Bigger problems?”

“Yeah, bigger problems.”

“Bigger problems than the entire hotel possibly being drugged-up?!”

“Well ... I don’t know about that but there’s Commies up in the jail area now.”

“Commies?!”

“Yeah, Commies.”

“What the hell do you mean Commies?! You mean like the Russian hooker Commies?”

“No, not the Russian hooker Commies, the Commies Agus was talking about the other day. From boarded-up Kuta. Living up here in the jungles and stealing power and water from the hotel.”

I thought about that.

“Are you serious?!” Trying to figure that out. “But wait ... what makes you think they’re Commies?”

“Because they’re all wearing Che Guevara shirts with black hats and red stars on them.”

Huh? ... Seriously?!

“Is that what Commies wear?!”

“I don’t know? But they’ve got Beehive, Lil’ Shmoogy and Deebag all tied up there at the tree line building some kind of waterboarding device for them.”

“Waterboarding device?! What the hell are you talking about waterboarding device? They’re gonna waterboard them?!”

“We don’t know? But they’ve also got Hippie Jon and German Gunther up there too. Inside some kind of Native American Tee-Pee things, or sweat lodges, that they call WigWams of Truth.”

“WigWams of Truth?!”

“Yeah. And they think German Gunther is a Nazi!”

“A Nazi?!” I thought about that a second ... *Oh shit! Commies hate Nazi’s ...* “But, wait. What the hell’s a WigWam of Truth?!”

“We don’t know! That’s just what they call them. But they’re all up there at the tree line. Just standing there on the top rice paddy getting ready to start waterboarding them.”

“Oh crap!” Was all I could think of to say as I just sat there in the dirt. Not really believing what I was hearing. When Olof continued.

“And we think they’ve converted some of Mama’san’s Mudbugs into becoming Commies too!”

“Seriously?! ... Why do you think that?”

“Cause they’re also wearing Che Guevara shirts with black hats and red stars on them.”

Hmmmm ... yeah, I guess that did kinda make sense.

“But wait. Hold on.” Thinking about that some more as well as Mama’san being the police force around here. “Where’s Mama’san and what’s she doing about all this?”

“She’s back there standing off to the side of the pool deck. Just watching it all behind some banana trees with her two little Trainees.”

“Why isn’t she stopping it?”

“We don’t know. This all just started happening a few minutes ago, we’ve just been watching it all from up here on the balcony. It’s frickin’ crazy!”

I just sat there a moment. In the dirt. Thinking about it all and what we should do about it.

“What do you guys think we should we do about this? Do you think I should go over there? To Mama’san? And see if she can help us out here and tell us what’s going on?”

“Yeah, you should definitely go do that.”

Hmmmm, wait a minute. Easy for him to say. Was that a good idea? I didn’t know. I mean I did have a mission to find Karen and calm her down. But I also didn’t want our guests getting waterboarded by a bunch of Commies up at the tree line. So this was another tough one. And figured I should really take care of this Commie situation first then deal with Karen second. And I guess the Klan guys third.

“But wait. Hold on. What about Karen? Have you guys seen her at all?”

“No. We keep looking for her but can’t find her anywhere.”

“Hmmmm ... ok ... I guess I’ll go over to Mama’san and see if I can find out what’s going on around here and call you guys back later.”

“Ok, cool.”

I hung up the phone and hopped out of the red hibiscus and yellow frangipani trees and hustled over to the back side of the hotel, up the matching 10’ marble staircases, and out onto the back pool deck area to where Mama’san was just standing behind some banana trees watching the whole thing with her two little Trainees standing right beside her watching the whole thing too.

“Mama’san.” I said finally getting next to her. Completely out of breath. Bent over. With my hands on my knees feeling a little bit like Agus and the beach ladies.

“What’s going on here? What’s this I hear about Commies up in the jail area?”

She didn’t answer me. Just continued standing there. Staring out across the vegetable fields out onto the top rice paddy. Seemingly deep in thought. Wondering about something. Or trying to figure something out. Like almost looking solemn. Sad. Or forlorn. With her two little baby Trainees flanked on either side of her. Also looking solemn, sad, or forlorn.

Then she finally answered me. Or grunted ... *Mmmmmmm* ... And nothing else. A somewhat more-lower-octave meditative grunt. One I’d never heard before so wasn’t really sure what it meant. But she was obviously deep in thought. Just watching it all.

So I stared out across the vegetable fields too. Out across the four rows of rice paddies. Each one stacked-up higher than the last. Tapered and tiered-up towards the final top row. Which was about 25’ deep and 50’ wide with the tree line and jungle directly behind it. And a bunch of Commie girls in their Che Guevara shirts setting up this new waterboarding device and Beehive, Lil’ Shmoogy and Deebag all tied-up at the tree line just watching-on in wide-eyed anticipation.

Then I looked around for Hippie Jon and German Gunther but couldn’t find them anywhere. And figured they must be inside one of the WigWams of Truth. Just behind the tree line. A few little Native American tee-pee-looking things all in a line. With little trails of smoke coming out of the tops of them.

Then I saw a single, young Commie girl come marching out of one of the WigWams of Truth over towards the top rice paddy. Looking kinda like their leader or something since she was wearing a different colored Che Guevara shirt and start gesturing toward another group of Commie girls to start dragging Lil’ Shmoogy over to the waterboarding device.

Uh oh. I thought.

Then looked back over at Mama’san.

“Mama’san, what’s going on here?! What’s happening?”

She took a deep breath and let out a more contemplative sigh. A low-rumbling ... *Mmmmmmm* ... this time. And replied back. Almost sadly.

“That Mekong.”

“Mekong?!” I said scrunching my face up and staring directly at her, feeling very confused.
“Who – or what – is a Mekong?”

“Mekong my niece.”

Your niece?

“Your niece?!” I was completely surprised by that. And did not expect that one at all. “You’re niece? Are you serious? She’s your niece?!”

“Yes.” She drew out forlornly. “Had sister back in North Korea. And sister have child. Young Mekong. Very special child. Very gifted. Love Mekong very much. Treat her like own daughter.”

Oh my God. I had no idea Mama’san had a niece. Let alone a sister. Man, she’s just full of surprises.

“Mekong grow up and educated in finest North Korean schools. Alongside children of State Dignitaries. North Korean high society. Best and brightest. Learn all about Communism. Socialism. U.S. Imperialism and Guerilla Warfare. As well as great Communist leaders like Marx, Ho Chi Minh, and Che Guevara. She very proud and wise child. But find out later, she learn too much.

Oh man. I wasn’t really sure I had time for some kind of history lesson right now.

“She learn how corrupt North Korean version of Communism is. And others too. She know true wishes of Marx, Ho Chi Minh, and own personal hero Che Guevara. And angered at how bad current leaders take advantage of beliefs and principles ... ‘To each according to needs, from each according to abilities.’ ... she believe in slogan.”

I just stood there. Trying to be polite. And respectful. And did appreciate her telling me all about the Communist slogan but was actually more concerned about this place just completely spinning out of control and me possibly getting arrested – or framed by Karen – than the backstory of her young niece Mekong and her idealistic belief system. But also knew that Mama’san didn’t like to be interrupted, so decided to just wait there patiently for her to finish.

“When husband send in mercenaries to smuggle me out of North Korea, I insist they take sister and young Mekong too. But mercenaries fail. Only get me. And government catch sister and kill her for being part of plan. Even though she not. But spare young Mekong because she such good student of Communism. But they did not know truth.”

I wondered how much longer this was going to take since I could now see her young niece Mekong ordering the Commie girls to start strapping Lil’ Shmoogy down to the waterboard device.

“After that day I make solemn vow – promise to heavens and pledge of honor – that I will get young Mekong out. And save money. Until finally save enough to pay mercenaries to get her out. And this time they succeed. Get Mekong out to be reunited with me. Only to find out she did not want to get out. She was planning revolution in North Korea. To overthrow Great Leader. Had assembled army and was ready to go. But I ruined plan. And now she no forgive me. And curse and hate me for what I do. And run off.”

I just stood there. Thinking more about this. And about how horrible it must have been for Mama’san to go through. And endure. While also watching her young niece Mekong now encircling around Lil’ Shmoogy and throwing some kind of brownish mud-water in her face.

“I try to apologize and make things right. But she no listen. Mekong so angry now. Filled with rage. Then run away from me. And disappear. Hear stories she was living in boarded up Kuta. Recruiting other girls to join her. To join cause. But did not know she came up here. And now lives up here in the jungles. Doing what ... I do not know.”

I looked back at Mama'san. Feeling sorry for her. While also noticing the pain in her eyes. The deep sadness. And tried to figure out how I was going to say, what I needed to say.

"Mama'san, I'm so sorry to hear that. I really am. That's just so awful that that happened to you. And I feel really bad for you, and that you had to go through all that, as it must have been an incredibly difficult experience for you to deal with, and process and cope with. And I hate to be rude here – or insensitive to your needs – but can you just tell me real quick why your young niece Mekong seems to be running some kind of Communist revolution up here in the jungles behind the hotel with five of our guests either tied-up in WigWams of Truth or about to be waterboarded?"

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"Drink the truth!! Purge your lies!!" Mekong roared out as she threw the brownish mud-water down the back of Lil' Shmoogy's throat who now gagged and coughed and tried to spit it back out all the while squirming about on the waterboard.

"You fucking bitch, I'll fucking kill you!" Lil' Shmoogy screamed out while choking and gagging and thrashing about. "Get me the fuck off this thing you fucking Commie bitch! This is fucking buuuullshit!!"

Oh crap! I thought as Mama'san and her two Trainees now started to walk from the back pool deck down the stairs to the little dirt path while positioning themselves behind a row of banana trees to get a closer look without being seen. With me following closely behind them.

"What are you doing here?! What are you looking for?!" Mekong bellowed out as I poked my head between two banana leaves.

"I ain't looking for shit bitch! These fuckers threw me in jail! Racist motherfuckers!! I didn't do shit!!" Lil' Shmoogy hollered back while still squirming about and trying to get free.

A drop of rain hit the top of my head as I looked up to see a massive gray thunderhead forming overhead. Coming down the southern slope of Mt. Batur and headed our way. *Oh boy*, I thought. A storm was coming and it looked like a big one.

"Lies!!" Mekong roared out while continuing to pace around Lil' Shmoogy.

"It's not a fucking lie you bitch! I was fucking framed. By some little Chinese boy!" Wriggling about and yanking the ropes binding her wrists to the waterboard. "And if I ever get my hands on that little fucker I will ... Fuck ... Him ... Up!!" Thrashing about and visibly upset.

Mekong was lording over her. Looking like a fierce guerilla-warfare fighter. Or one of those other descriptions you used to read about in those old racist Colonialist novels. With a savage beauty to her. A beastlike virility. Tribal sexuality. Primitive elegance. Barbaric and untamed. Primal and bloodthirsty. Feral yet feminine. Her shoulder-length black hair hanging perfectly about her face looking like she belonged on the cover of Vogue magazine's 'Exotic Warriors of the Jungle' edition.

She circled menacingly around Lil' Shmoogy with the rain now coming down harder and her cheaply-made Che Guevara shirt clinging to her wet, raw, sinewy body.

“Drink the truth!! Purge your lies!!” She yelled out throwing more mud-water in her face.

“Stop throwing that shit in my face!!”

“Stop spewing your lies and hypocrisy!”

Her demeanor was hardened. Like North Korean military hardened. Yet her features were almost angelic in their ferocity. Somewhat hidden behind an apparent disgust of modern U.S. beauty standards. Masking the true intent of God’s work. Seemingly unaware or embarrassed of her own natural splendor.

“What are you doing here?! What are you looking for?!”

“I already told you, I ain’t looking for shit bitch!! These fuckers threw me in jail!!”

Mekong did not seem to buy that while she continued to circle around her throwing more mud-water in her face. “Do you deny you have come here seeking DonMu and the cave of enlightenment?!”

Lil’ Shmoogy now stopped. And wrenched her head to the side. Seemingly pausing on that. Like she was surprised Mekong even knew about that name.

“What tha’ fuck you talking about?!” Looking at her confused. “I ain’t looking for that motherfucker! Those racist white hippies are the ones looking for him. So go tie them up. I’m here for the Reality TV show part of this thing. So get me the fuck off this thing you fucking Commie bitch!”

“What do you think lies up here you Imperialist-Colonialist swine?!”

“I don’t give a fuck what lies up here! And I ain’t no Imperialist either! Or a goddamn Colonialist! I’m black like you guys!”

Mekong now stopped. And twisted her head around. With a new look in her eyes. Not really buying that one either.

“You’re not black like us! You’re nothing like us! You are rich capitalist swine come here to steal from us!!”

“Bitch, I ain’t stealing shit! I’m the one who’s tied up here in case you hadn’t noticed!”

The rain was coming down harder now. The winds picking up. Thunder rumbling off in the distance.

“You Americans are always going to places you aren’t wanted. Stealing from them. Spreading your lies and propaganda. Colonizing sovereign nations with your Neoliberalist Foreign Policy. IMF. World Bank. CIA black-ops. Installing your puppet dictators and rigged central banking systems with your corporate media lapping along behind spewing their imperialist propaganda whilst trying to mask the true intents of their 1% white slave masters.”

“Bitch, I don’t know what the fuck you’re talking about!! You’re bat-shit crazy! But I hate America too! They’re all fucking racists over there. Old racist white men discriminating against everyone and keeping everyone down. Fuck those racist motherfuckers, I’m with you guys!!”

Mekong did not seem to buy that one either.

“You’re not with us! You’re with them!” She snarled. “Sent here by them to appropriate and colonize us. Steal from us and profit off us. We know about you. We heard about you. They showed us your ridiculous social media pages and your pitiful YouTube rap videos.”

Lil’ Shmoogy now stopped. And wrenched her head back to the side. Seemingly surprised she knew about that one too.

“What tha’ fuck you talking about?!”

Mekong now turned to one of the Babybugs – to one who might have been recently converted into a Commie and possibly ratted Lil’ Shmoogy out to Mekong – spotted her and yelled out.

“Bring me her YouTube channel!”

Lil' Shmoogy now winced and looked a little nervous. Probably unsure of what they had on her. And started to sweat. While the Babybug hustled over to Mekong and got right next to her, pulled out her phone, scrolled through it to find Lil' Shmoogy's YouTube video on it – found it – pressed play – and handed it to Mekong who stared at it in utter disbelief.

“What the fuck is this shit?!”

“What the fuck is what shit?!”

“Why you dance around like a monkey?!”

Her eyebrows shot up. “You fuckers better stop calling me that!!”

Mekong threw the phone down in the mud in disgust.

“Look at you!! Dressing up in indigenous African clothing trying to use them for your own self-promotion and profit. Thinking they're your people when they are not your people. They are more our people than your people! What you ever done for them? What have you ever sacrificed for them? What have you ever bled for them? Your people as you call them?! If they are your people then go help them!!”

Lil' Shmoogy seemed confused by that.

“What the fuck am I supposed to do go over there and live there or something?! Fuuuuuck that shit!!”

“Hypocritical swine!” Mekong threw more mud-water in her face.

“Stop throwing that shit in my face!!”

“You claim to be discriminated against. You claim to be prejudiced against. You claim to be a victim of racism, oppression, bigotry, and the white male patriarchy! Well, guess what...?” She snarled right in her face. “We feel it too!!” Growling fiercely while gnashing her teeth. “... And now you have an opportunity to join us!! ... to join us and overthrow the rich white racist American swine together!!” Rain still pouring down all around her. “Will you take this opportunity? Will you take this entreaty? Will you take this call to action and stand with the girls right next to you. The comrades right beside you. Who have dropped everything. Sacrificed everything. Risked everything. And pledged themselves to the fight?!!”

Lil' Shmoogy now peered around at all the other Commie girls standing there. Dressed in their cheaply made Che Guevara shirts, ratty-old cargo pants, emaciated bodies and muddy combat boots. And didn't seem to want that for herself.

“Fuck that!! It's easy for them to drop everything cause they ain't got shit to lose!”

“Filthy American swine!!” Mekong wailed. “Don't you want your reparations?!”

Lil' Shmoogy now stopped. And wrenched her head back to the side. With a new look to her face. Seemingly surprised that Mekong knew about that word too. And what it possibly meant to her. And gazed at her with a look of hopeful optimism.

“I can get that shit?!” She said eyes bugged out and intrigued.

“Join us in the jungles and we will plot and plan and prepare and train and go rip the reparations from the cold dead hands of your rich white American swine together!!”

Lil' Shmoogy's expression now changed back to one of more reluctant hesitation. Probably realizing the amount of work that was involved in this and apparently changed her mind.

“Fuuuuck that shit! I want my reparations but I want someone else to get 'em for me!”

“Greedy American swine!!” Mekong roared out and threw more mud-water in her face then turned back around to her comrades.

“Throw her in the Wigwam of Truth ... to dwell on her lies ... and bring me the next one!”

Her comrades now started untying Lil' Shmoogy from the waterboard and began dragging her back behind the tree line, throwing her inside one of the WigWams of Truth, while two other Commie girls now started dragging Beehive on over.

"Aaiiihhhh!! Aaiiihhhh!!" Beehive shrieked out while I looked over at Mama'san with a look of panic on my face.

"Mama'san we gotta stop this! We gotta stop this right now!"